

Tobias Treppmann

Design systems shaped by how the organization actually works

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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PORTFOLIO

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
2022 – 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland
2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Design systems

DTCG design tokens · Style Dictionary · Storybook · Figma variables and live library sync · multi-platform token pipelines · component APIs and specifications · design-system governance and contribution paths

Accessibility

EU Accessibility Act audits · WCAG contrast checked in code · screen-reader semantics and ARIA · AI-generated alt text in production across six countries

Building and tools

Prototyping in real code against production APIs · Android and Kotlin · SwiftUI · React and web · Claude Code, Cursor and Zed as daily tools

Governance and strategy

Balancing standardization and flexibility on shared foundations, so innovation stays possible · tools, governance and workflows · integrating new technology · design strategy tied to business and product goals · change management · mentoring outside a reporting line

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organizations.

PROFILE

Design leadership in enterprise and consumer software, with the design system in my brief in each of the last three roles. At Bibel TV nothing was tokenized and every change went through an external engineering agency, which made small changes slow and expensive. What I built answers that rather than a textbook: DTCG tokens in four tiers, synced live to Figma and Android. The component and view tiers exist so radius, type size and spacing change in the token API, not in an agency ticket.

One commit, four platforms

DTCG tokens built with Style Dictionary and synced live to Figma — iOS, Android, web and connected TV move together

Changes without a release

component and view token tiers, so radius, type size and spacing are the company's to change rather than the agency's

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web and connected TV) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- One design system, four platforms — DTCG design tokens built with Style Dictionary and synced live to Figma and Android. One commit updates iOS, Android, web and connected TV.
- Token tiers as a control surface — the component and view tiers alias downward and add no new values, so radius, type size and spacing change in the token API rather than in an agency ticket.
- Brought the external engineering agency with me — the architecture takes billable change work away from them, and they backed it anyway.
- Self-serve for people who are not designers — Storybook as the shared surface, and the people prototyping with it are product managers and engineers.
- Enforcement in the build — checks on every build and in CI reject a token reference that does not resolve, or a color written in by hand. Neither is a visual difference, so nothing else catches them.
- Color engine in production — themes built from content artwork, with WCAG contrast validated inside the algorithm.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- EU Accessibility Act compliance — we audited our own site and the sites customers build on the platform. Those are made by parish staff, so the standard had to hold without them.
- AI-generated alt text, shipped — across six countries, under GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law.
- Booking module — the plan was a standalone add-on; I argued for building it into the platform and delivered it that way. 70% less coordination time, 90% acceptance.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Shared design-system governance — a working group of four designers and engineering, with a clear path for settling disagreements. Motion carried in the system as shared easing curves.
- Ran design and product at the same time — for four months, nine people across design, UX writing, product management and data science, on the senior leadership team. Hired two, promoted two.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Turned a services business into a product catalog — with the executive team of a listed group, and ran the design-thinking training for leadership.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Defined how components behaved — what each one did, what it guaranteed and where it could be used, across the design system library.
- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years, setting the design bar across both sites.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade reviewing and critiquing designers' work

Mentor · *Interaction Design Foundation* · 2020 – 2022 · Remote

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany · 200+ people

Earlier · *UX Manager, UX Designer, Web Developer* · 2009 – 2014 · Pennsylvania, USA